

The Battle of Endor

Overview

The Battle of Endor was the decisive engagement of the Galactic Civil War, fought in 4 ABY above and on the forest moon of Endor. It resulted in the destruction of the second Death Star, the deaths of Emperor Palpatine and Darth Vader, and the effective collapse of the Galactic Empire. More than a military victory, Endor represented the fulfilment of an ancient Jedi prophecy and the redemption of Anakin Skywalker — the Chosen One who at last brought balance to the Force.

Background

Following the Alliance's victory at the Battle of Hoth, the Empire accelerated construction of a second, more powerful Death Star in orbit above Endor. Emperor Palpatine himself oversaw the final stages, sensing an opportunity to use the station as bait. He fed intelligence to the Rebellion, allowing them to learn the shield generator's location and the incomplete state of the battle station's defences — all part of a calculated trap designed to destroy the Rebel fleet and crush the Alliance once and for all.

The Emperor's Trap

The Rebel Alliance took the bait, committing their full fleet to an assault on the Death Star. Han Solo led a commando team to the forest moon to destroy the shield generator that protected the station, while Admiral Ackbar commanded the Rebel fleet in space. Luke Skywalker surrendered himself to Darth Vader, intent on confronting the Emperor and believing he could turn his father back to the light. The Emperor anticipated all of it.

The Ground Battle

On the forest moon, Han's team was captured shortly after landing, but an unlikely alliance with the native Ewoks turned the tide. Despite their primitive technology — spears, catapults, and logs — the Ewoks launched a fierce guerrilla assault on Imperial forces. Their knowledge of the terrain and ferocious determination caught the Empire's professional soldiers off guard. After fierce fighting, Rebel commandos led by Han Solo destroyed the shield generator bunker, exposing the Death Star above.

Space and the Throne Room

In space, the fleet found the Death Star fully operational — the Emperor's deception laid bare. Admiral Ackbar's command of 'It's a trap!' became the battle cry of desperate resistance. The Rebel fleet, caught between Imperial Star Destroyers and the Death Star's superlaser, fought for survival. Meanwhile, in the Death Star's throne room, Luke refused to strike down his father and faced the Emperor's wrath. Vader, moved by his son's selfless love, intervened — hurling the Emperor into the reactor shaft at the cost of his own life. Anakin Skywalker died having fulfilled his destiny.

Aftermath and Legacy

With the shield down and Anakin's sacrifice complete, Lando Calrissian flew the Millennium Falcon into the Death Star's core and destroyed the reactor, escaping moments before the station exploded. The Imperial fleet, leaderless and demoralised, fell into disarray. Across the galaxy, people took to the streets in celebration. The Galactic Empire had not ended entirely — remnants would fight on for years — but Endor broke its heart. The New Republic rose from the ashes, and the age of darkness begun at the fall of the Jedi was over at last.